Tech Dessert #4: Control Operator, Station ID, and Repeaters

Companion reference for meeting 4 -- who is in charge of a station, how and when you identify, and how repeaters and clubs work.

Groups T1E + T1F · 22 pool questions · Self-study handout · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

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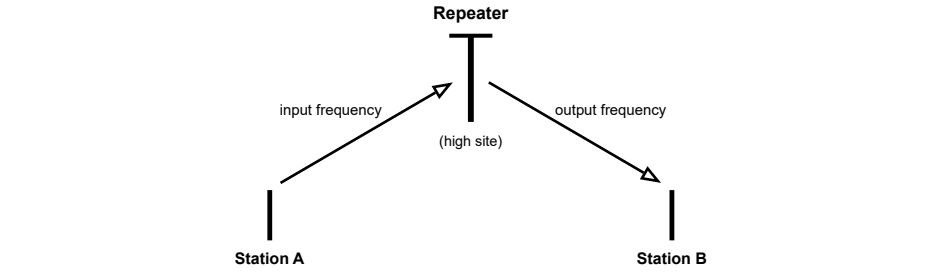
This Dessert is a reference sheet – facts to learn, not problems to solve. Read the tables, study the repeater diagram, then drill the question bank until the answers come automatically.

The Control Operator

Topic	What to know	Q
Can a station transmit with no control operator	**Never** – a control operator must always be in charge.	T1E01
What a control operator is	The amateur the licensee **designates as responsible** for the station's transmissions and rule compliance.	T1E11
Who designates the control operator	The **station licensee**.	T1E03
What a "control point" is	The **location where the control operator function is performed**.	T1E05
What sets a station's transmitting privileges	The **license class of the control operator**.	T1E04
A Technician as control op in an Extra-only segment	**Not at any time.**	T1E06
Responsibility when the control op is not the licensee	**Both** the control operator **and** the station licensee.	T1E07
Control operator for a satellite or space station	Any amateur **allowed to transmit on the satellite's uplink frequency**.	T1E02
Example of automatic control	**Repeater** operation.	T1E08
Which stations may be remotely controlled	**Any** station.	T1E09
Example of remote control	Operating the station **over the internet**.	T1E10

Identifying, Repeaters, and Clubs

Topic	What to know	Q
How often to send your call sign	At least **every 10 minutes** during a contact, and at the **end**.	T1F03
Identifying when using tactical calls ("Race HQ")	Still send your FCC call sign **every 10 minutes** during and at the end.	T1F02
Language for identification on phone	**English.**	T1F04
How to identify on a phone (voice) transmission	Send the call sign by **CW or by phone**.	T1F05
Self-assigned indicators (e.g., KL7CC/W3)	"stroke," "slant," and "slash" are **all acceptable**.	T1F06
What a repeater is	A station that **simultaneously retransmits** another station's signal on a **different channel**.	T1F09
Who is accountable for a violation a repeater retransmits	The control operator of the **originating station**.	T1F10
What "third-party communications" means	A message passed by a control operator to another station's control operator **on behalf of someone else**.	T1F08
Third-party contact with a foreign station	That country must have a **third-party agreement** with the U.S.	T1F07
When you must allow station inspection	At any time, **on request by an FCC representative**.	T1F01
Requirement for a club station license	The club must have **at least four members**.	T1F11



A repeater listens on its input frequency and simultaneously retransmits on its output frequency, extending two stations' range far beyond line of sight.

Remember: every transmission has a **control operator** – designated by the licensee, responsible for the station, and the person whose license class sets what the station may do. Identify with your call sign **every 10 minutes and at the end** of a contact. A **repeater** receives on one frequency and retransmits on another, and the **originating** station – not the repeater – answers for what it sends.

Dessert 4 Question Bank (T1E + T1F)

T1E01. When may an amateur station transmit without a control operator?
A. When using automatic control, such as in the case of a repeater
B. When the station licensee is away and another licensed amateur is using the station
C. When the transmitting station is an auxiliary station
D. Never

T1E02. Who may be the control operator of a station communicating through an amateur satellite or space station?
A. Only an Amateur Extra Class operator
B. A General class or higher licensee with a satellite operator certification
C. Only an Amateur Extra Class operator who is also an AMSAT member
D. Any amateur allowed to transmit on the satellite uplink frequency

T1E03. Who must designate the station control operator?
A. The station licensee
B. The FCC
C. The frequency coordinator
D. Any licensed operator

T1E04. What determines the transmitting frequency privileges of an amateur station?
A. The frequency authorized by the frequency coordinator
B. The frequencies printed on the license grant
C. The highest class of operator license held by anyone on the premises
D. The class of operator license held by the control operator

T1E05. What is an amateur station's control point?
A. The location of the station's transmitting antenna
B. The location of the station's transmitting apparatus
C. The location at which the control operator function is performed
D. The mailing address of the station licensee

T1E06. When, other than during an emergency, may a Technician class licensee be the control operator of a station operating in an Amateur Extra Class band segment?
A. At no time
B. When designated as the control operator by an Amateur Extra Class licensee
C. As part of a multi-operator contest team
D. When using a club station whose trustee holds an Amateur Extra Class license

T1E07. When the control operator is not the station licensee, who is responsible for the proper operation of the station?
A. All licensed amateurs who are present at the operation
B. Only the station licensee
C. Only the control operator
D. The control operator and the station licensee

T1E08. Which of the following is an example of automatic control?
A. Repeater operation
B. Controlling a station over the internet
C. Using a computer or other device to send CW automatically
D. Using a computer or other device to identify automatically

T1E09. Which amateur stations may be remotely controlled?
A. Only repeater stations
B. Only automatically controlled stations
C. Only digital stations
D. Any station

T1E10. Which of the following is an example of remote control as defined in Part 97?
A. A software defined radio (SDR)
B. Operating the station over the internet
C. Controlling a model aircraft, boat, or car by amateur radio
D. Earth-Moon-Earth (EME) communication

T1E11. What is a control operator as defined in Part 97?
A. The person speaking or otherwise communicating messages over an amateur station
B. The person who is the licensee of an amateur station
C. An amateur operator identified in the FCC database as responsible for transmissions and FCC rules compliance at a station license location
D. An amateur operator designated by the licensee of a station to be responsible for transmissions and FCC rules compliance at that station

T1F01. When must the station licensee make the station and the station records available for inspection?
A. At any time ten days after notification by the FCC of such an inspection
B. At any time upon request by an FCC representative
C. At any time after a written notification by the FCC of such inspection
D. Only when presented with a valid warrant by an FCC official or government agent

T1F02. How often must you identify with your FCC-assigned call sign when using tactical call signs such as "Race Headquarters"?
A. Never, the tactical call is sufficient
B. Once every hour
C. At least every 10 minutes during and at the end of a communication
D. At the end of every transmission

T1F03. When are you required to transmit your assigned call sign?
A. At the beginning of each contact, and every 10 minutes thereafter
B. At least once during each transmission
C. At least every 15 minutes during and at the end of a communication
D. At least every 10 minutes during and at the end of a communication

T1F04. What language must you use for identification when using a phone emission?
A. Any language recognized by the United Nations
B. Any language recognized by the ITU
C. English
D. English, French, or Spanish

T1F05. What method of call sign identification is required for a station transmitting phone signals?
A. Send the call sign followed by the indicator RPT
B. Send the call sign using a CW or phone emission
C. Send the call sign followed by the indicator R
D. Send the call sign using only a phone emission

T1F06. Which of the following self-assigned indicators are acceptable when using a phone transmission?
A. KL7CC stroke W3
B. KL7CC slant W3
C. KL7CC slash W3
D. All these choices are correct

T1F07. Which of the following restrictions apply when a non-licensed person speaks to a foreign amateur radio station via a station under the control of an FCC-licensed amateur radio operator?
A. The person must be a U.S. citizen
B. The foreign station must be in a country with which the U.S. has a third-party agreement
C. The licensed control operator must do the station identification
D. All these choices are correct

T1F08. What is the definition of third-party communications?
A. A message from a control operator to another amateur station control operator on behalf of another person
B. Amateur radio communications where three stations are in communications with one another
C. Operation when the transmitting equipment is licensed to a person other than the control operator
D. Temporary authorization for an unlicensed person to transmit on the amateur bands for technical experiments

T1F09. What type of amateur station simultaneously retransmits the signal of another amateur station on a different channel or channels?
A. Beacon station
B. Remote control station
C. Repeater station
D. Message forwarding station

T1F10. Who is accountable if a repeater inadvertently retransmits communications that violate the FCC rules?
A. The control operator of the originating station
B. The control operator of the repeater
C. The owner of the repeater
D. Both the originating station and the repeater owner

T1F11. Which of the following is a requirement for the issuance of a club station license grant?
A. The trustee must have an Amateur Extra Class operator license grant
B. The club must have at least four members
C. The club must be registered with the American Radio Relay League (ARRL)
D. All these choices are correct

Answer Key

T1E01: D	T1E02: D	T1E03: A	T1E04: D	T1E05: C
T1E06: A	T1E07: D	T1E08: A	T1E09: D	T1E10: B
T1E11: D	T1F01: B	T1F02: C	T1F03: D	T1F04: C
T1F05: B	T1F06: D	T1F07: B	T1F08: A	T1F09: C
T1F10: A	T1F11: B			